

B”H

לקוטי תורה - אני לדודי

(notes by Shaul Wertheimer)

Al pi pshat, Elul is the month of חשבון. Prepare for יום הדין. Teshuva, regret etc.. a serious month. The minhag of shofar is to make us tremble.

In this maamer, the Alter Rebbe turns the month around to a month of powerful love & kiruv.

The love of Elul is alluded to in Shir HaShirim. This possuk indicates that our relationship with Hashem is not only that of Master/slave and King/nation, but also Lover/Beloved.

What is the answer to the Alter Rebbe's question?

1. Not “full” hisgalus in Elul, therefore it’s not a yontiff.
2. Since not “full” hisgalus, therefore it’s not a contradiction to Ani L’dodi, rather it’s just a נתינת כח.

What is the meaning of the revelation of the 13 Attributes of Mercy?

1. **Pshat:** A person sins and asked Hashem for compassion and atonement.
2. **Chassidus:** Inner/deep kiruv between Hashem and a Yid’s neshama, which causes a התעוררות to come closer to Hashem.

Story of R. Pinchas of Koretz, that he felt on Yom Kippur that the Maggid thought of him... *that’s* פנימיות.

What is פנימיות הרצון? Analogy of work.

Two types of mesiras nefesh:

1. Literally;
2. מסירת הרצון.

משם ובקשתם: Search as if after a lost object. What is lost? Hashem can’t be lost! → The neshama is in golus!

1. Search *there*, i.e. your thought, speech & action – then Hashem will have compassion.

What if it doesn’t work?

1. Aderaba: there should be even more רחמנות that you don’t feel anything!
2. אש שלמעלה (fasting)